

Welcome to the South Bay STEM Association Team!

Our mission is to ignite a passion for STEM in every student, ensuring equal access and opportunity for all, regardless of background.

Our vision is a world where every child is empowered with the knowledge and skills to become a future innovator, leader, and problem-solver in the fields of science, technology, engineering, and math, creating a brighter and more equitable future for all.

As a volunteer with the South Bay STEM Association, you'll be mentoring and inspiring young students through hands-on STEM activities and workshops. Whether you're teaching coding, guiding engineering challenges, or assisting with events, your impact will help shape the next generation of innovators.

To help us create a fun, safe, and impactful learning environment, we expect you to be professional and reliable. Engage with the students, helping and supporting them whenever needed. You don't have to be an expert- just come with a willingness to learn, inspire, and grow together as a team.

For now, please do the following four tasks:

1. Write a **cohesive paragraph** for your **website biography** with the following information:
 - Name
 - School and grade
 - Position (Default position is volunteer unless otherwise stated)
 - Why you love STEM and why you joined South Bay STEM Association
2. Print and sign the [volunteer contract](#)
3. Print and sign the [SBSA Photo Release Form.docx](#)
4. Provide a nice photo of yourself

Email **all four items** to volunteer@southbaystem.org at your earliest convenience. You will **NOT** receive any volunteer hours until these items have been received.

Volunteer hours may be earned in the following ways and will be recorded by the secretary (Owen Yeh):

- ❖ **Workshops & Programs:** Volunteer hours will be tracked using a sign-in sheet at each event.
- ❖ **Board Member Allowance:** Board members and Directors will receive a minimum of **3 hours per month** for completing tasks assigned by the **CEO** that fall outside of regular meetings and workshops/programs. These tasks may include, but are not limited to, sending receipts, responding to emails, and working on documents. The secretary will record these hours. However, the CEO reserves the right to revoke this allowance if the tasks are not sufficiently completed.
- ❖ **Board Member Meetings:** Attendance at board meetings counts toward volunteer hours but is not included in the monthly allowance

Current Existing Programs:

Zero Robotics

Zero Robotics is an immersive five-week coding competition hosted by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology. In this program, students learn to program virtual robots in a simulated space environment using both block coding and C. Along the way, they develop core programming skills, problem-solving abilities, and an understanding of real-world robotics applications.

Working in teams, participants create and refine code to complete space-themed challenges. Finalist teams earn the unique opportunity to have their code run on actual robots aboard the International Space Station, operated by NASA astronauts.

Volunteers meet with teams and guide them through the program. They monitor students' progress and also assist with the field day.

(RUNS DURING THE SUMMER ONLY)

STEM Workshop Program

Our STEM Workshop program delivers hands-on, interactive learning experiences to elementary school students. Through engaging activities and experiments like building sturdy bridges, creating the most aerodynamic paper airplane, or making magnetic slime, students explore core concepts in science, technology, engineering, and math in a fun, accessible way.

These workshops encourage creativity, critical thinking, and teamwork, sparking curiosity and a lasting interest in STEM. Designed to go beyond the traditional classroom, the program empowers students to learn, collaborate, and innovate.

Volunteers help come up with STEM workshop topics and mentor students through the duration of the workshop.

(RUNS DURING THE SCHOOL YEAR)